

Now run an SMTP command at the blank line:

```
ehlo localhost
```

And scan for these two lines:

```
250-STARTTLS
```

```
250-AUTH PLAIN LOGIN
```

If they show up, congratulations. TLS works. Type in **quit** and get out of there.

Configuring e-mail clients

For e-mail clients, use the following settings:

1. Incoming server type: POP3 (or POP)
2. Outgoing server type: SMTP
3. Incoming server encryption: TLS
4. Outgoing server encryption: TLS
5. Incoming authentication type: PLAIN
6. Outgoing authentication type: PLAIN or LOGIN
7. Outgoing server requires authentication: Yes
8. POP Server: <The server with the MX record>
9. IMAP Server: Same as POP Server
10. Usernames: The username in question without the "@domain" part.

Technical information

1. Mail storage format: Maildir
2. Maildir location: `/var/mail/username` [The Maildir is actually a file]
3. User account system: One mail account per user in the system. This effectively means that anyone who wants a mail account on our server has to have a user account on the mail machine. This is a bit cumbersome, and can be avoided by setting up and instructing both Dovecot and Postfix to authenticate against a LDAP server, such as Fedora Directory Server or OpenLDAP. This is a huge operation.
4. Protocols supported: SMTP and ESMTP for the MTA; POP, IMAP, POPs (Secure) and IMAPs (Secure) for mail client synchronisation.

Further enhancements

There are a lot of enhancements you can do to this set-up. Some of them are listed below:

1. Secure the server with SpamAssassin and ClamAV. SpamAssassin is a spam filter from Apache

Foundation, and ClamAV is an open source anti-virus. Please note, however, that scanning each mail against a gazillion rule files to find spam, and then scanning them against signatures and heuristic rules to find viruses and malware scripts, will take a humongous amount of processing power and slow the system down considerably. Here's a resource: postfixmail.com/blog/?p=360.

2. Install a Web mail interface. This one is fun. Most, if not all, Web mail apps use IMAP, so there're almost no disk space requirements on the Web mail-hosting Web server. Note, however, that CentOS' old version of PHP (5.1.6) means that no decent-looking Web mail app will run on it. I tested out RoundCube and @Mail Open. But, yes, there's always the tried-and-tested Squirrel Mail, which more or less works under all circumstances.
3. Get yourself a directory server for central authentication, and configure Postfix and Dovecot to authenticate against them. You'll have an added advantage because you can actually get machines themselves to authenticate against LDAP, and you'll never need an `/etc/passwd` file again. I'll cover Fedora Directory Services at the end of the series, unless you people want it earlier, of course.

Next!

What will we do next? Let's see... How about a collaboration platform? Video conferencing, Internet Relay Chat, maybe Jabber, a groupware suite... yeah. That'll be it. And after that? How about a storage grid? With multiple low-powered machines handling about 50 to a 100 terabytes of Network-Attached Storage? Patience... 

Reference

How To Forge Perfect CentOS Server article: www.howtoforge.com/perfect-server-centos-5.3-x86_64-ispcfg-2-p5

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